

I am my own Grandpa

All the buzz about the Hadron Collider spewing out miniature black holes that will eat up the planet, or opening up gateways to alien invasion, or bringing about an anti-matter cataclysm has died down, mostly because the \$6.4 billion project seems to be doing almost nothing.

Now a bunch of scientists have unearthed a paper that claims to explain exactly why the Doomsday Machine is not working. The Collider was built to create and observe a certain "God Particle", something that apparently proves or disproves some theories of physics that only physicists really care about. It won't even solve the energy crisis, or cure cancer, or for that matter, open gateways to alien civilisations. What it does, however do, according to some physicists, is create particles that nature dislikes so much, that there is a glitch in the space time fabric. Now this glitch travels back in time, and creates a parallel universe where the particles cannot be created in the first place. This is something like nature having a restore point. You may point out a dozen holes in this whole scenario, but how else can you possibly explain so many scientists working so hard and just creating the world's largest and coldest fridge? We just wish nature hated humans as much as the Higgs-Boson.

tech art: MSPaint Art



Image Credit: Grape Candy

Go to **Start** > **Run** and type **mspaint**, use the basic set of tools to go wild, and it is an art form. There are videos posted on YouTube that are too good to be true, and they are. These are worked backwards in Photoshop to look like they have been made on MSPaint. However, there are some exemplary examples on the web that really stand out. There are some pretty advanced tricks you couldn't have guessed using the basic tool set. This is before the advanced version of MSPaint in Windows 7 was around. Most MSPaint art is used for pixel art or sprite art, but a few really big, really great works are around. Head over to http://www.neopets.com/~grape_candy for a really great tutorial. Also, bookmark www.paintmash.com for more examples and an active MSPaint art community.

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For those who came in late

Muddled by so many terms used in the mag? Here's your short guide to the tech lingo

Heatsink: Any structure or device on a motherboard that dissipates the heat produced by the processor.

Chipset: The kind of architecture, or the design of a processor. Devices based on the same chipset are compatible with each other.

Northbridge: The area on an Intel motherboard which is reserved for the RAM and graphic card slots.

QWERTY: Short for a QWERTY slider, a form factor in phones that incorporates a keyboard with individual keys for every letter for easier type input.

Heuristic: Heuristic scanning in Anti-Virus software is an approach where different processes on a system are monitored for their behavior. Based on past experience, if the behavior is suspicious, then the Anti-Virus software alerts of a possible infection by malware.

Upscaling: Changing the resolution of a video. The process is called upscaling even if the resolution is reduced, the "up" is an indication of the intended display. Commonly used in screens.

PSU: Power Supply Unit, the part of a computer that provides the electricity to all the components of the system.

API: An Application Programming Interface describes methods in which third party coders can use the resources of a web app.